

BEYOND THE KINGDOM

Episode #0006

Air Date: Monday, January 10, 2005

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Story Day: Friday, January 7, 2005, 10:39 PM – Monday,
January 10, 2005, 11:02 PM EST

Teleplay by the Beyond the Kingdom Writers' Room
Final Shooting Script

CAST OF CHARACTERS – EPISODE #0006

(ages as of Monday, January 10, 2005)

THE DONOHUES: SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94) · VICTOR DONOHUE (68)

THE OLSONS: MARTIN OLSON (23) · MALLORY OLSON (19)

THE BULLOCKS: ROBERT BULLOCK (45) · NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) · CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24) · DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) · MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) · GRACE BULLOCK (20)

THE SMILLEYS: ODESSA SMILLEY (84) · LUCIUS SMILLEY (55) · VIVIANNE SMILLEY (49) · ESTHER SMILLEY (22)

THE CHILDREN: EMMA SMILLEY (2) · VICTORIA SMILLEY (2) · LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2)

THE CIRCLE: AMOND BAKER (22) · ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) · HARMONY DIVINE (22)

THE SEVEN: TOBIAS "THE LEDGER" OKAFOR (24) · KEISHA "GHOST" LATTIMORE (25) · ROMAN GAINES (28) · DOLORES "MAMA DEE" WHITFIELD (53) · RASHAD "SAINT" MAYFIELD (23)

RECURRING: CAMILLE RHODES (38) · SPECIAL AGENT KATHLEEN "KATE" DOYLE (34) · SPECIAL AGENT DANIEL "DANNY" REYES (29) · SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57) · RUBY MAE "NANA RUBY" TOLLIVER (66) · BEATRIX "NANNY BEA" PENNINGTON (43)

INTRODUCING: INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (47), Fulton County DA's Office, Cold Case Unit

DAY PLAYERS: BERNICE WHITLOCK (Lamar's widow) · KEYONNA (7) · DEANDRE (9) · NURSE TONYA · APD EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN · NATHANIEL GREER (Director of Global Security, Donohue Hotels & Resorts, by phone) · MERRIWEATHER NEPHEW, TEDDY (silent)

MENTIONED, NOT SEEN: Joan Donohue (Manor) · Thaddeus Crowe · Reverend Oscar Peavy · the person on the other end of Martin's call · Alvin Donohue (Miami) · Darnell "Dee" Divine · Desmond Smilley

FADE IN:

TEASER

1 EXT. NORTHSIDE DRIVE NW – THE CURVE – NIGHT

Friday, January 7, 2005 – 10:39 PM EST

Black trees. A two-lane road that bends hard to the left above a wooded ravine. One streetlight, a hundred yards back, that doesn't reach this far. A steel guardrail, newer than the road, bolted in sometime in the last three years.

ARIANNA's silver BMW sits on the gravel shoulder with its engine running and its headlights pointed straight at the curve.

The driver's door is open.

ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) stands at the guardrail in her stocking feet. No coat. Her hands are flat on the cold steel. She's staring down into the dark.

Headlights sweep around the bend behind her. An ASTON MARTIN DB9 brakes hard, tires chewing gravel, and stops nose-to-tail with the BMW.

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) is out before the engine is off. He's in a gray sweatshirt and jeans, no jacket, exactly what he was wearing when the phone rang.

MARC

Ari.

She doesn't turn.

MARC (CONT'D)

I told you not to get out of the car.

ARIANNA

(to the ravine)

They put a guardrail up.

MARC

(coming closer, slow,
the way you walk up on
a spooked horse)

Spring of '02. The county did a study.

ARIANNA

A study.
(a terrible little
laugh)
A study said this curve was
dangerous.

MARC

Ari. Look at me.

ARIANNA

They're going to put his picture
up in my office, Marc. The
investigator. That's how she
works. She said so. She puts the
picture on the wall so she never
forgets whose case it is.
(beat)
I'm going to have to look at him
every day.

MARC

Look at me.

She finally turns. Her face is wrecked, wet, and blank at
the same time. Mascara. Blue ink still in the lines of her
right palm from the pen she snapped Thursday.

He takes her face in both his hands.

MARC (CONT'D)

(low and absolutely
steady)
I will handle this.
(beat)
I've always handled this.

ARIANNA

You handled HIM.
(beat)
Who handles her? Who handles
Harmony? She thanked me, Marc. On
the internet. She thanked me in
front of the whole world.

MARC

(beat)
Me.

He pulls her into his arms. She breaks against his chest,
a sound coming out of her that's barely human, three years
deep.

He holds her. His eyes are open over her shoulder, fixed on the guardrail, the ravine, the dark.

WIDE: two small figures in the headlights at the edge of a curve that the county made safer too late.

SMASH CUT TO:

MAIN TITLES — "KINGDOM"

ACT ONE**2 EXT. GREATER CASCADE BAPTIST CHURCH – CASCADE ROAD – DAY**

Saturday, January 8, 2005 – 10:51 AM EST

A cold, brilliant Saturday. A red-brick church with a white steeple on Cascade Road, Southwest Atlanta. A MERRIWEATHER & SONS hearse, black and polished to a mirror, idles at the curb with its back door open.

On the church steps, something Atlanta has never seen.

On the LEFT side of the steps, twenty MERRIWEATHER MEN in black suits and black overcoats. Old heads and young ones. Silas's people.

On the RIGHT side, twenty BLACKWATER MEN in charcoal suits and charcoal overcoats. Saint's people. SAINT MAYFIELD (23) stands at the top, hands folded in front of him like an usher.

They don't look at each other. They don't have to. They stand shoulder to shoulder down both rails of the stairs, making an aisle for the widow.

Church mothers in wide black hats pass between them, staring.

ACROSS THE STREET – ELXA'S UNMARKED CROWN VICTORIA

CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24), in a black wool coat over plain clothes, sits behind the wheel. DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) is in the passenger seat with a paper cup of coffee going cold in his hand.

JEREMY

I've been a cop four years. I've never seen that.

ELXA

Nobody's seen that. Merriweather and whoever the hell that is on the right, standing on the same steps. In 1994, those two families would've shot each other over a parking space.

JEREMY

That's not a truce. That's a press release.

ELXA
(watching Saint)
It's a statement.

JEREMY
Saying what?

ELXA
That neither one of them did it.
(beat)
And that they want whoever did to
see them standing together.

Jeremy follows her eyeline down the block. A dark-blue Ford Taurus with government plates is parked at the corner.

JEREMY
Company.

In the Taurus: SPECIAL AGENT KATE DOYLE (34) behind the wheel, and SPECIAL AGENT DANNY REYES (29) with a long-lens camera, shooting through the windshield. CLICK. CLICK. CLICK.

ELXA
(not surprised)
The FBI photographs funerals. Of
course it does.

The church bells begin to ring.

A black Cadillac pulls up behind the hearse. The driver opens the rear door.

SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57), in a black cashmere coat and a gray homburg, steps out. Two fingers of his left hand are crooked. Old breaks, badly set.

He turns and offers that hand, the crooked one, back into the car.

MAMA DEE WHITFIELD (53), in a black church suit and a black hat with a small veil, takes it and steps out.

On the steps, every man on both sides straightens.

Elxa leans forward.

ELXA (CONT'D)
(quietly)
Who is that?

JEREMY

Dolores Whitfield. Dee's Kitchen.
Best smothered chicken on the
West Side.

In the Taurus, Reyes lowers the camera.

REYES

(to Doyle)

The lady with the veil. Both
sides straightened up for her.

DOYLE

I saw.

REYES

Somebody's mother?

DOYLE

(writing on a legal
pad: "DEE'S KITCHEN -
WHITFIELD")

Somebody's somebody.

CUT TO:

**3 INT. GREATER CASCADE BAPTIST CHURCH – FELLOWSHIP HALL
– DAY**

Saturday, January 8, 2005 – 1:22 PM EST

After the burial. The repast. Long folding tables with white paper tablecloths, church ladies behind steam pans of fried chicken, green beans, macaroni and cheese, and pound cake. The room is full and loud. Grief turning into eating, the way it does.

BERNICE WHITLOCK (40s), Lamar's widow, sits at the head table in black. People bend to hold her hands. She is dry-eyed, exhausted, and holding a plate she hasn't touched.

Across the hall, near the coffee urn, Mama Dee and Silas stand side by side, each holding a paper cup. They are the calmest two people in the room.

SILAS

Friday night came and went,
Dolores.

MAMA DEE

I know what day it is.

SILAS

Your boy promised proof by
Friday. I got a coin with the
wrong number of waves on it and
your word.

MAMA DEE

You got more than that. You got
the shooter's van burned up in
Clayton County with a church's
plates on it. You got two men
dead who never paid a dime to
anybody but you and us. And you
got my word.

(beat)

My word used to be enough for
you.

SILAS

(beat)

Your word was always enough for
me. It's his I've never heard.

MAMA DEE

You're hearing it through me.
That's how it works.

Silas looks across the hall. Saint stands at the back
wall, arms folded, watching everything. A young
MERRIWEATHER NEPHEW, TEDDY (20s), sharp-dressed and
restless, stands at the opposite wall, staring right back
at Saint.

SILAS

(nodding at Teddy)

My sister's boy. Theodore. They
call him Teddy.

(beat)

Teddy thinks your people killed a
deacon and a loan man to scare
us, and he thinks I'm old for
letting it slide. He's got
friends that think so too.

MAMA DEE

And what do you think?

SILAS

I think Earl Tuggle owed me four thousand dollars from 1985, and I never once asked him for it, because he came to my wife's wake and stood in the rain for two hours.

(beat)

And I think somebody wants me to think what Teddy thinks. That's what I think.

MAMA DEE

Then keep Teddy on a leash.

SILAS

I'll keep him as long as I can keep him.

(beat)

Tell your boy I'm going to be patient. But tell him it's a Merriweather kind of patience. It runs out on a Tuesday, it doesn't say so on a Monday.

He sets down his cup. He crosses to Bernice.

Mama Dee watches him go. Then she catches Saint's eye across the hall and gives him one small nod.

Saint walks to the head table. He bends down and says something quiet to Bernice. He puts a plain white envelope in her hands and closes her fingers over it.

Bernice looks up at him.

BERNICE

Who are you?

SAINT

Nobody, ma'am. A friend of the deacon's.

(beat)

It's the mortgage. Through the end of the year. And the funeral's been paid.

BERNICE

(stunned)

Mr. Merriweather said the funeral was—

SAINT

Mr. Merriweather's a gentleman.
So he won't mind.

Across the room, Silas sees the envelope. He sees Saint.
He sees Bernice press it to her chest.

He tips his homburg a half-inch to Saint. Saint nods back.

Teddy sees it too, and his jaw tightens.

CUT TO:

**4 INT. CAMILLE RHODES'S CONDOMINIUM – THE PARK PLACE ON
PEACHTREE – THE BEDROOM CLOSET – MORNING**

Saturday, January 8, 2005 – 7:52 AM EST

Earlier that same Saturday. A thirty-fourth-floor condo,
all white and glass, with a view straight down Peachtree.

ROBERT BULLOCK (45), in weekend clothes, a quarter-zip and
driving loafers, stands in the doorway of a walk-in closet
the size of a studio apartment. He has never once been
here on a Saturday.

CAMILLE RHODES (38), in a silk robe with her hair down,
walks past a long rail of women's suits to the end, where
a man's white dress shirt hangs by itself on a wooden
hanger. Turnbull & Asser, with French cuffs.

Camille takes it down. She doesn't fold it. She holds it
out on the hanger.

CAMILLE

She asked.

ROBERT

She asked where it went. I told
her the car.

CAMILLE

(evenly)

You told Natasha Donohue you left
a four-hundred-dollar shirt in
the car for five days.

ROBERT

(beat)

She said she'd look in the car.

A small, sharp smile from Camille.

CAMILLE

Then you'd better put it in the car.

He takes the shirt from her. He's already turning to go.

CAMILLE (CONT'D)

Robert.

He stops.

CAMILLE (CONT'D)

Six years. You've never once come here on a Saturday.

(beat)

And the first time you do, it's for a shirt.

ROBERT

(quietly)

Camille. Not now.

CAMILLE

It's always "not now." "Not now" is the only time zone I live in.

He looks at her. For a second, the man she fell in love with is in his face: tired, tender, sorry.

ROBERT

I'll call you tonight.

CAMILLE

You won't.

ROBERT

(beat)

I'll call you Monday.

He goes. The front door closes.

Camille stands alone in the enormous closet. She looks at the empty wooden hanger.

Then she looks at the glass bottle on the vanity behind her: a heavy crystal flacon with a gold stopper shaped like a pair of smiling lips. SMILE.

She picks it up. Turns it in the light.

She had five days to wash that shirt.

She didn't.

CUT TO:

5 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE – THE MORNING PARLOR – MORNING
Monday, January 10, 2005 – 7:31 AM EST

Monday morning. The pale-yellow parlor where Simone has taken breakfast for forty years. Winter light through old wavy glass. A silver coffee service. Grits, eggs, and a basket of biscuits under a linen napkin.

SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94), in a lavender cashmere twinset and her everyday pearls, sits at the round table with her back perfectly straight.

Marc sits across from her in a navy suit, tie loosened already, his plate full. He looks like he's slept maybe four hours since Friday.

MARC

Gorgeous, I'm telling you. It's not a feud. It's a hostage situation.

SIMONE

Your grandfather is not a hostage. He's a guest in his own library, and he has twenty thousand books to keep him company. All he needs is to stop calling mayors when his wife asks him not to.

(beat)

I sent chamomile.

MARC

Grandma said she asked you for it.

SIMONE

She did.

(beat)

That's the part that matters. When a woman is angry enough to banish a man to the library and still asks her mother-in-law for his tea, the marriage is fine. It's the man who isn't.

Marc smiles into his coffee. Simone watches him over her biscuit.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

Saint Mayfield brought your car
through the Crown Gate at
one-twenty Saturday morning, and
you came home in Arianna
Cummings's automobile at
eleven-fifteen Friday night.

(beat, pleasantly)

The gatehouse sends me a list. It
has since 1958. Nobody ever
remembers.

Marc sets down his coffee.

MARC

Ari had a bad night.

SIMONE

I'm sure she did.

(beat)

That child hasn't looked me in
the eye in three years.

MARC

She's shy.

SIMONE

Something happened to Arianna
Cummings the winter after the
towers came down. Christmas of
2001 she was at my table.
Christmas of 2002 she sent a
card.

MARC

(evenly)

She went to law school, Gorgeous.
It'll do that.

Simone looks at him for a very long moment. Then she lets
it go, deliberately, the way she might set down a teacup
she's decided not to throw.

SIMONE

The Smilley girl.

Marc goes very still.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

The one in red. At your birthday.
She turned around.

MARC

I heard.

SIMONE

You didn't just hear. You froze
the picture.

(off his look)

Officer Hollis's wife sings in my
choir.

MARC

(beat, admitting
nothing)

She came to the gate twice. Once
the morning they moved in, and
once in a ball gown. I just want
to know why.

SIMONE

(sipping her coffee)

Of course you do.

MARC

Do you know why?

SIMONE

(beat)

I know that when a woman drives
to a gate in a red Valentino, and
then turns around, she didn't
forget something at home.

(setting down her cup)

She remembered something.

Marc looks at her. Simone looks back, bright-eyed,
ninety-four and a step ahead.

MARC

Gorgeous. What happened in
Savannah?

SIMONE

(smiling)

Not on a Monday.

MARC

You always say that.

SIMONE

And it's always Monday when you
ask.

She lifts the linen off the biscuit basket and puts one more on his plate.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

Eat. You have sick children to read to.

CUT TO:

6 INT. BELLE RIVE – THE LAUNDRY ROOM – MORNING

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 8:07 AM EST

A big, bright laundry room off the kitchen wing: two washers, two dryers, a pressing station, and a long folding counter under a window onto the frosted back lawn. It smells like starch and Downy.

NANA RUBY TOLLIVER (66), in a housedress and a cardigan, sorts Monday's whites from a wicker hamper into piles with brisk efficiency. The radio plays WAOK. A gospel hour.

NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) appears in the doorway, dressed for the office in an ivory St. John suit, briefcase in hand, on her way out. She says good morning and turns to go. Behind her, Ruby lifts a man's white dress shirt out of the hamper by the shoulders, shakes it out, and hesitates.

Just a second. Just long enough.

Natasha sees the hesitation. She turns back.

NATASHA (CONT'D)

What?

RUBY

(beat)

Nothing, baby.

NATASHA

Ruby.

Ruby looks at the shirt. Then she folds it once over her arm and holds it out.

RUBY

Mr. Robert brought it in out of the Mercedes on Saturday afternoon. Held it up in the kitchen like he'd caught a fish.

(beat)

"See? The car." That's what he
said. Twice.

Natasha sets down her briefcase. She takes the shirt.

Turnbull & Asser. French cuffs. Robert's monogram on the
pocket: R.J.B.

She lifts the collar to her face.

Holds it there.

Her eyes close.

Under the starch and the cologne she knows, something
else. Tuberose. Something green and cool underneath. A
little vetiver. Warm skin.

NATASHA
(very quietly, eyes
still closed)
Smile.

RUBY
Ma'am?

NATASHA
(opening her eyes)
It's called Smile. Vivienne
Smilley's perfume. It came out in
Paris two years ago. Saks started
carrying it at Phipps in
December. The bottle looks like a
pair of lips.
(beat)
Four hundred dollars an ounce.
Robert has never bought a woman a
four-hundred-dollar bottle of
anything in his life.
Five days in a car, Ruby. A shirt
doesn't keep a woman's perfume
for five days in a car.
(beat)
It keeps it in a closet.

Ruby says nothing. There's nothing to say.

Natasha folds the shirt carefully, perfectly, collar and
cuffs, the way Joan taught her when she was eight. She
holds it against her chest.

NATASHA (CONT'D)
Wash everything else.

RUBY
And this one?

NATASHA
This one I'm keeping.

She picks up her briefcase and walks to the door. She stops.

NATASHA (CONT'D)
(without turning)
Ruby.

RUBY
I know.

NATASHA
You didn't find anything.

RUBY
(beat, gently)
Baby, I haven't found anything in
this house in twenty-five years.

Natasha goes. Ruby stands at the folding table. She looks at the pile of Robert's undershirts.

She turns the radio up. The choir swells.

RUBY (CONT'D)
(to herself, dropping
the whites into the
machine)
Lord, hold her up. And hold me
back.

FADE OUT.

ACT TWO**7 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – MORNING**

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 8:58 AM EST

The DA's corner office on the fourth floor of the courthouse at 136 Pryor Street. Boxes still half-unpacked from a week ago. A view of the gold dome of the Capitol three blocks away.

Arianna sits at her desk in a charcoal suit, hair pulled back tight, makeup flawless. Nobody looking at her would ever know about Friday night. On the credenza, a vase of white roses from her parents, already drooping.

She picks up the phone and dials.

ARIANNA
(into phone)
Chief Jackson, please. It's the
District Attorney.

INTERCUT WITH:

INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S OFFICE – CONTINUOUS

Elxa at her desk, in uniform, with four stars on each collar point and a mug that says WORLD'S OKAYEST DAUGHTER, a gag gift from Grace. Her office is a converted Sears storeroom and still looks like one.

ELXA
(into phone)
Arianna. You got my voicemail.

ARIANNA
I got it Friday night. I'm sorry.
I had a family thing.

ELXA
You never have family things.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Two coins, Elxa.

ELXA

Two coins at Big E's. The one in his hand had six crests. The one on the counter behind the register had seven. Thumb-worn. Old. I think it had been sitting in that cash drawer since before I made captain.

ARIANNA

A protection coin.

ELXA

That's my theory. Earl Tuggle paid somebody to leave him alone. The somebody left him a coin. Then somebody ELSE came along and killed him and put a fake in his hand.

(beat)

Whoever's killing these men isn't Blackwater, Ari. It's somebody who wants us to think it's Blackwater.

ARIANNA

(carefully)

Or it's Blackwater, and they're smart enough to plant a fake so you'll think exactly that.

ELXA

The FBI filed for a court order Friday afternoon. For the coins. All of them.

ARIANNA

Judge?

ELXA

Federal magistrate. Carver.

ARIANNA

Then she'll sign it this morning. Carver signs everything before her second cup of coffee. Photograph everything. Every coin, every angle, under the scope. Keep your own chain of custody. When they send it back — and they'll send it back — you'll know if it's the same coin.

ELXA
(writing)
Already done. Jeremy did it
Friday night.

ARIANNA
Then you're ahead of them.

ELXA
(beat)
Arianna. The canary meeting. It's
still on for Wednesday.

ARIANNA
Good.

ELXA
Hughes asked this morning if we
could move it. Mayor Whitaker's
budget hearing got pushed to
Wednesday morning, and all the
deputy chiefs have to testify.
He's pushing for Thursday.

ARIANNA
Then Thursday. It doesn't matter
what day. It matters what he
hears.

ELXA
(quietly)
If it's him, Ari. If he's the
leak.

ARIANNA
Then you'll know in an hour. And
then you decide what kind of
chief you are.

A beat on both women.

ELXA
Thank you. For the canary. It was
a good idea.

ARIANNA
It was your idea. I just told you
it was legal.

Elxa almost smiles. She hangs up.

In the DA's office, Arianna sets down the receiver and
sits back.

On her desk: the thin brown folder. MP-2002-0014.

She's taken it out of the bottom drawer. She's put it on top of her desk where anyone could see it. She lays her palm flat on the cover.

A KNOCK at her door.

CUT TO:

8 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – CONTINUOUS

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 9:16 AM EST

The door opens before Arianna says come in.

INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (47) walks in. A small, solid woman in a brown pantsuit that's seen a few years of courtrooms, low heels, and reading glasses on a beaded chain around her neck. She carries a canvas tote bag that says GBI CRIME LAB 1992 FAMILY PICNIC and a steel thermos of her own coffee.

She has a face people tell things to. She knows it.

CARLA

Madam District Attorney. Carla Mims. I'm sorry. I knock and then I walk in. My husband says it's the only rude thing about me.

ARIANNA

(standing, extending
her hand)

Ms. Mims. Please. Come in. You already have.

CARLA

(shaking her hand, a
firm, dry grip)

Carla.

ARIANNA

Arianna.

CARLA

No, ma'am. Not in this building. I call the District Attorney "Madam District Attorney." I called Mr. Tate "Mr. District Attorney" right up until the day they took his parking spot away.

She sits without being asked. She opens the thermos, pours coffee into its cap, and sets the canvas bag on the floor.

CARLA (CONT'D)
I read the Divine file this weekend. All nine days of it.

ARIANNA
(sitting)
And?

CARLA
And it's a disgrace.

ARIANNA
(evenly)
What do you need?

CARLA
Everything. But let me tell you how I work first, so you're not surprised.

She reaches into the canvas bag. She takes out a manila envelope. She slides out a photograph and lays it on the desk.

An 8x10 enlargement of the flyer photo. DARNELL "DEE" DIVINE, age 22. A cap turned backward. A big, easy grin. A gold chain. His arm is thrown over somebody who's been cropped out of the frame.

Arianna doesn't let herself look away from it.

CARLA (CONT'D)
I put him up. Everywhere I work, I put him up on the wall. So every time I lift my head, I see whose case it is. It's not superstition. It's discipline.
(beat)
You mind if I put a copy in here?

ARIANNA
(beat)
I don't mind.

CARLA
Good.

She takes a second copy out of the envelope, stands, and walks it to the corkboard by the window. She pins it up with a red pushpin, right at eye level from Arianna's desk

chair.

Dee grins down at the District Attorney.

Carla sits back down and picks up her coffee.

CARLA (CONT'D)

The file says he left a private party on the 3100 block of Northside Drive at around a quarter to two in the morning. On foot. No car. The party host was a man named Lamont Grier. Dee's cousin's friend. House party, sixty, seventy people, music, a lot of Hennessy.

(beat)

Nobody at Lamont Grier's saw him after he left. Ray asked. That's the one thing Ray did.

ARIANNA

Then where do you start?

CARLA

With everybody else.

(beat)

New Year's Eve on Northside Drive, Madam District Attorney. That's not a street, that's a ballroom. Between West Paces and Moores Mill there are forty houses, and I'd bet my pension on this: that night, six or seven of them were throwing a party.

(beat)

Sixty people at each. Four hundred people. Coming and going on that road between midnight and four in the morning, in cars, with headlights.

Arianna's hand is flat on her desk. Very still.

CARLA (CONT'D)

Somebody saw a young man walking. Somebody always sees. They just never know it mattered.

(beat)

So I want the guest lists. Every private party on Northside Drive between West Paces Ferry and Moores Mill on December 31, 2001.

Caterers, valets, bartenders, the security companies. Rich folks hire all four, and all four keep paper.

ARIANNA

(beat)

That's a lot of doors in a very particular zip code.

CARLA

Yes, ma'am. Rich folks don't love a cold-case investigator on the porch. That's why I need a letter on your letterhead, over your signature, telling them the District Attorney of Fulton County personally asks for their cooperation.

She slides a typed letter across the desk. Arianna's own letterhead. A space at the bottom for a signature.

Arianna reads it. Her eyes stop halfway down the page.

INSERT – THE LETTER: "...all residences hosting private gatherings on Northside Drive NW, between West Paces Ferry Road and Moores Mill Road, on the night of December 31, 2001-January 1, 2002..."

BACK TO SCENE

Arianna looks up. Carla is watching her over the rim of the thermos cap. Kind eyes. Patient eyes.

CARLA (CONT'D)

Something wrong with it?

ARIANNA

(beat)

"Personally" is a strong word.

CARLA

It's supposed to be.

Arianna picks up her pen, a heavy black Montblanc, a gift from her father for her swearing-in.

She signs it.

Arianna Cummings. District Attorney.

She slides it back across the desk.

CARLA (CONT'D)
(taking it, folding it
once, sliding it into
the canvas bag)
Thank you, Madam District
Attorney.
(standing, gathering
her things)
I'll call the family this
afternoon. Mrs. Divine said she'd
see me any day but Sunday.
Sunday's church.
(beat)
And the sister. Harmony. She's
the one who didn't let it go.

ARIANNA
She never let it go.

CARLA
(at the door)
The ones who never let it go are
the reason I have a job.
(beat)
Oh. Madam District Attorney. You
grew up around there. Belmont
Crest's right off Northside.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Yes.

CARLA
Where were you that New Year's?

A frozen beat.

ARIANNA
(evenly)
I was nineteen, Carla. I was at a
party.
(beat)
Like everybody else on Northside
Drive.

CARLA
(smiling, easy)
Well, then. You'll be on my list
too.
(beat)
That's a joke.

She goes. The door closes.

Arianna sits alone. Dee's photograph smiles at her from the corkboard.

She doesn't move for a long time.

CUT TO:

**9 INT. CHILDREN'S HEALTHCARE OF ATLANTA AT EGLESTON –
PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY PLAYROOM – DAY**

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 10:34 AM EST

The playroom: primary-colored beanbags, a fish tank, a bookshelf, and paper snowflakes taped to the windows. A handful of KIDS in pajamas and hospital bracelets, some bald, some with IV poles, are gathered on a big alphabet rug.

Marc sits cross-legged on the rug in his navy suit pants and a white shirt with the sleeves rolled up, his jacket thrown over a tiny chair. In his lap is a hand-bound book. The cover is a child's watercolor of a purple dinosaur wearing a tiara.

KEYONNA (7), bald, fierce, in pink pajamas, sits pressed right up against his knee. DEANDRE (9), in a Falcons jersey over his hospital gown, sits a skeptical foot away with his IV pole beside him.

NURSE TONYA (40s), in cartoon scrubs, leans in the doorway, arms folded, enjoying herself.

MARC

(reading, big voice)

"And the Dinosaur Princess looked at the whole entire Kingdom of Snacks, and she said: 'I am a princess, AND I am a dinosaur, and I do not have to choose.'"

KEYONNA

(triumphant, to
DeAndre)

SEE?

DEANDRE

That's not a real book.

MARC

It's extremely real. You're looking at it.

DEANDRE

You wrote it.

MARC

I wrote it this weekend. That's what makes it real. Keyonna told me Thursday there aren't any books about dinosaur princesses. So now there's one.

DEANDRE

(pointing at the cover)
Who drew that?

MARC

(beat)
I did.

DEANDRE

(flat)
It looks like a grape with a hat.

The kids CRACK UP. Marc clutches his chest like he's been shot.

MARC

(recovering, back to the book)
"And the Dinosaur Princess ruled the Kingdom of Snacks for a thousand years, and everyone was allowed to have seconds, and nobody ever had to take medicine that tasted like pennies."

A beat. The kids go quiet at that. They all know medicine that tastes like pennies.

KEYONNA

(small)
Does she get married?

MARC

The Dinosaur Princess?

KEYONNA

Uh-huh.

MARC

(considering it seriously)
Only if the prince is funny.

KEYONNA
Are you funny?

DEANDRE
No.

MARC
(to DeAndre)
I will put you in the sequel as a
grape.

More laughter. In Marc's pocket, his phone BUZZES. He glances at it. BRIELLE. He lets it buzz.

It buzzes again. GHOST.

He closes the book gently.

MARC (CONT'D)
Okay. Chapter two Thursday.
Keyonna gets to name the dragon.

He stands. He gives Keyonna the book. She holds it with both arms like it might escape.

KEYONNA
I get to keep it?

MARC
It's yours. You're the princess.

She beams. In the doorway, Nurse Tonya has to look at the ceiling for a second.

**10 INT. EGLESTON – THE HALLWAY OUTSIDE THE PLAYROOM –
CONTINUOUS**

Marc walks and pulls on his jacket at the same time, phone to his ear.

MARC
(into phone, quiet)
Go.

KEISHA (V.O.)
(filtered)
Two things. One: our friend at
Deputy Chief level made another
phone call from his personal cell
Saturday night. Eleven-forty.
Nine minutes. Same WBKG desk.

MARC

The funeral.

KEISHA (V.O.)

That'd be my guess. It led the eleven o'clock. "Rival Gangs Stand Together at Slain Deacon's Funeral." With footage. Somebody told WBKG exactly which church and exactly what time.

MARC

And two?

KEISHA (V.O.)

Italy's done. All four shops. None of them has cut onyx in that pattern, none of them has shipped more than fifty stone discs to anybody in the last two years.

(beat)

Seven shops left. Germany, India, Hong Kong, Israel, South Africa. I'll have Germany by tonight.

(beat)

Tobias found something at Chatham Savings. He wants to show you in person. He says don't make him say it on a phone.

Marc stops walking.

MARC

Tonight. The Table. Nine o'clock.

He hangs up. At the end of the hall, a little bald boy in a wheelchair waves at him. Marc waves back, smiling. The smile drops the second he turns the corner.

CUT TO:

11 INT. CITY HALL EAST — APD HEADQUARTERS — EVIDENCE ROOM — DAY

Monday, January 10, 2005 — 11:21 AM EST

A caged basement room. Steel shelving, bar-coded boxes, a long counter under a fluorescent tube that flickers. An APD EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN (50s), sleeves rolled, stands behind the counter with a clipboard.

On the counter: three small plastic evidence bags, each holding one black onyx coin.

Elxa stands on one side of the counter with Jeremy. On the other side, Doyle and Reyes. Doyle holds a folded document with a blue backing.

DOYLE
Federal Magistrate Carver. Signed
at eight-fifty this morning.

Doyle sets the order on the counter. Elxa picks it up and reads every line. Then she sets it down.

ELXA
(to the Custodian)
Release them. Full chain of
custody. Photograph the transfer.
Both agents sign, I sign, you
sign.

EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN
Yes, Chief.

The Custodian begins the paperwork. Doyle leans on the counter, watching Elxa.

DOYLE
You're not going to fight me.

ELXA
You got a court order. I'm a
police officer. That's the whole
relationship.

DOYLE
(beat)
Three coins.

ELXA
Three coins.

DOYLE
But your command-staff report
only lists two.

The room gets quiet. Jeremy looks up from his clipboard. The Custodian stops writing.

ELXA
(evenly)
How do you know what's in my
command-staff report?

DOYLE
Because I read it.

(beat)
Somebody faxed it to our field
office Saturday morning. No cover
sheet. No name.

A long, hard beat. Elxa's jaw sets.

ELXA
(very quietly)
From what number?

DOYLE
A Kinko's on Ponce.

ELXA
(beat)
Of course it was.

DOYLE
(studying her)
You kept the third coin out of
your own report. On purpose.

ELXA
Yes.

DOYLE
Why?

ELXA
(beat)
Because my report leaks.

Doyle holds her look. For the first time, something like
respect passes between them.

DOYLE
(quietly)
So you're running a mole hunt in
your own building. In your first
month.

ELXA
I'm running a murder
investigation, Agent Doyle. The
mole is just in the way.

The Custodian slides the transfer form across the counter.
Doyle signs. Reyes signs. Elxa signs last, hard, the pen
almost tearing the paper.

Doyle picks up the three bags. She holds the one with the
seven-crest coin up to the flickering light.

DOYLE
They don't kill their own
customers. I said that Friday.

ELXA
You did.

DOYLE
I'm starting to think somebody
wants me to arrest the wrong man.

ELXA
(beat)
Then don't.

Doyle pockets the bags. At the cage door she turns.

DOYLE
Chief. When you catch your mole.
I'd like to be told before I read
it in the paper.

ELXA
When I catch my mole, Agent
Doyle, you'll read it in the
paper like everybody else.

Doyle almost laughs. She goes. Reyes follows, giving
Jeremy a sympathetic two-finger salute.

The cage door CLANGS shut.

JEREMY
(quietly)
A Kinko's on Ponce.

ELXA
He's not even trying to hide it.

JEREMY
He's not trying to hide it from
us. He's trying to make sure you
know he can.

CUT TO:

12 INT. PHIPPS PLAZA — PARKING DECK — LEVEL 3 — DAY
Monday, January 10, 2005 — 12:02 PM EST

The neutral ground. Concrete, fluorescent light, a Saks
delivery truck grinding its gears somewhere below.

The black Range Rover is already parked, engine running. AMOND BAKER (22), in a camel coat and jeans, stands at the open back door, unbuckling LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2) from a car seat. She's in a purple puffer coat and holding a stuffed giraffe by the neck.

The dented silver Honda Civic swings into the space beside him, a little fast. Harmony gets out in a black Keel & Associates blazer with her name badge still clipped on and her cell phone at her ear.

She looks at Amond. He looks at her.

The rules: no talking. Just the child, the bag, and ten minutes. A hundred times.

Amond sets Lyric on her feet. Lyric runs to her mother's knees.

LYRIC
MAMA! I rode the pony!

HARMONY
(scooping her up)
You rode the pony? In January?

LYRIC
Pony Marc!

HARMONY
(tight)
Pony Marc.

Amond takes a small duffel out of the Range Rover and holds it out. Harmony takes it without looking at him. She turns to her car.

AMOND
She had greens Sunday.

Harmony stops.

AMOND (CONT'D)
My mother made them. With a lot
of hot sauce. She ate two
helpings.
(beat)
I thought you'd want to know.

HARMONY
(beat, not turning
around)
Thank you.

She opens the back door of the Civic. She starts strapping Lyric into the car seat. Amond watches her. He doesn't get back in his car.

AMOND

I read the paper.

Harmony keeps buckling.

AMOND (CONT'D)

The Sentinel. Saturday. "New DA Reopens Case of Missing Southwest Atlanta Man." They quoted your LiveJournal.

(beat)

I can help.

Harmony straightens up. She closes the back door of the Civic on Lyric, who's already singing to her giraffe. Harmony turns and faces him.

HARMONY

Help.

AMOND

My company. BSI. We do this. We find people. We've got two hundred investigators on three continents, we've got analysts who can pull every traffic camera, every pawn ticket, every bus pass in this city for the last three years. We've got people who found a kidnapped oil executive in the Niger Delta in eleven days.

(beat)

Give me a week. I'll put the best people I've got on it. It won't cost your family one dime. You'll have—

The SLAP echoes off the concrete like a gunshot.

Amond's head turns with it. Somewhere below, a car alarm starts wailing.

Harmony's hand is shaking. Her eyes are blazing.

HARMONY

(low)

You think money fixes everything?

AMOND
(holding his cheek,
stunned)

I—

HARMONY
Three years. Three YEARS I
stapled my brother's face to
telephone poles on Campbellton
Road in the rain. I called APD
every Monday for eighteen months
until the desk sergeant knew my
voice and hung up on me. My
mother lit a candle in her front
window every night for a thousand
nights. My daddy drives around
the city on Saturdays looking at
men sleeping under bridges to see
if one of them's his son.
(beat)
Where was your two hundred
investigators then?

AMOND
(quietly)
I didn't know you then.

HARMONY
You knew me for ONE NIGHT.

The words hit the concrete and bounce.

Amond takes it. He doesn't touch his cheek again.

HARMONY (CONT'D)
(voice cracking)
And now a woman who never met him
in her life, a woman who's
twenty-two years old and doesn't
owe me anything, is looking for
him because it's her job and
because it's right. Not because
she's got a company. Because it's
RIGHT.
(beat)
You don't get to buy that. You
don't get to show up three years
late with a checkbook and take my
brother away from the one person
who's doing it for free.

AMOND
(beat)

That's not what I—

HARMONY

Every time, Amond. The Tiffany bag. The lawyers. The pony. Your mother's petition. Everything with your family comes with a price tag or a court date.

AMOND

(quiet, hurt)

My mother withdrew the petition.

HARMONY

Your mother offered to withdraw it for one Sunday a month. That's not withdrawing, that's a counteroffer.

A silence. The car alarm below finally stops.

From inside the Civic, muffled through the glass:

LYRIC (O.S.)

Mama? Daddy? You yelling?

They both turn toward the car. Lyric presses her face and her giraffe to the window, worried.

Harmony pulls herself together in one breath. She smiles at the window, a brilliant, fake, perfect mommy smile, and waves.

HARMONY

(through the smile, not moving her lips much)

Don't ever do that again.

AMOND

(through his own smile, waving at Lyric)

Hit me?

HARMONY

Offer.

She gets into the Civic. She pulls out without looking back.

Amond stands alone in the deck, waving at the taillights until they're gone. Then his hand drops.

He touches his cheek. It's already turning red.

AMOND
(to nobody)
Okay.

FADE OUT.

ACT THREE**13 INT. KEEL & ASSOCIATES REALTY – BUCKHEAD – HARMONY'S CUBICLE – DAY**

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 2:14 PM EST

A beige Buckhead office, forty cubicles under drop-ceiling lights. Harmony's desk is the one nobody wants, next to the restroom door, under the loudest air vent.

Her cubicle wall: a photo of Lyric on the pony, a Northwestern-purple mug of pens, and a FIND DEE flyer. A child's crayon drawing of a giraffe.

Harmony sits flexing her right hand. The palm is still pink.

Her desk phone RINGS. She picks up.

HARMONY

Keel and Associates, this is
Harmony Divine.

CARLA (V.O.)

(filtered)

Ms. Divine, this is Carla Mims.
I'm an investigator with the
Fulton County District Attorney's
Office, Cold Case Unit. I've been
assigned your brother's case.

Harmony sits bolt upright.

HARMONY

Yes. Yes, ma'am. Ms. Cummings
said you'd call.

CARLA (V.O.)

I read Darnell's file this
weekend. I'd like to come sit
with you and your parents. At the
house, if that's all right. I
find people remember better in
their own kitchens.

HARMONY

(grabbing a pen,
knocking the mug of
pens over)

Yes. Yes. Anytime. Whenever you
want.

CARLA (V.O.)
Your mother said anytime but
Sunday.

HARMONY
(half laughing, half
crying)
Sunday's church.

CARLA (V.O.)
Sunday's church. How about Friday
afternoon? Four o'clock?

HARMONY
(writing it on her
hand, on her palm, over
the pink)
Friday. Four. Yes.

CARLA (V.O.)
Ms. Divine. I want to be honest
with you so you don't hear it
from anybody else. Three years is
a long time. I can't promise you
what I'll find.

HARMONY
(beat)
Nobody's ever even promised to
look.

A pause on the line.

CARLA (V.O.)
(gently)
Then I'll promise that.
(beat)
I've got his picture up on my
wall already. And one on the
District Attorney's. I'll see you
Friday.

The line clicks off. Harmony sits holding the phone.

She looks at the flyer on her cubicle wall. Dee grins
back.

HARMONY
(whispering)
Somebody's looking, Dee.

She hangs up. She wipes her eyes fast with the heel of her
hand, the one that hit Amond.

Her cell phone BUZZES on the desk. The caller ID reads E.O.S.

She picks up.

HARMONY (CONT'D)
(into cell)
I slapped him.

INTERCUT WITH:

**INT. SMILLEY TOWER – 71ST FLOOR – ESTHER'S OFFICE –
CONTINUOUS**

An enormous white office with a curved glass wall looking directly across Peachtree Road at Donohue Tower. ESTHER SMILLEY (22) stands at the window in a black Armani pantsuit, phone to her ear. Behind her, on a white lacquer desk, a presentation binder: SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL ATLANTA – REAL ESTATE STRATEGY – CONFIDENTIAL.

ESTHER
(beat)
Hello to you too.
(beat)
You slapped who?

HARMONY
Lyric's father. In the Phipps deck. In front of Lyric.

ESTHER
(beat)
Did he deserve it?

HARMONY
(beat)
I don't know.
(beat)
He offered to find Dee.

Esther closes her eyes briefly.

ESTHER
With his company.

HARMONY
With his company. His two hundred investigators on three continents.

ESTHER
(carefully)
And you said no.

HARMONY
I said it with my hand.

ESTHER
(beat)
Harm. His company is very, very
good at finding people.

HARMONY
I don't want him to be good at
it. I want him to have been
THERE.
(beat)
The DA's investigator called.
Carla Mims. She's coming to
Mama's house Friday. She put his
picture on her wall.

ESTHER
(softening, then
briskly)
Tomorrow. Nine o'clock.
Seventy-second floor. The navy
suit.

HARMONY
Why do I have to be at your board
meeting?

ESTHER
(looking out at Donohue
Tower)
Because tomorrow morning I'm
going to make my brother's head
explode, and I want a witness.

HARMONY
(laughing despite
herself)
You're insane.

ESTHER
I'm a Smilley. It's genetic.
(beat, quieter)
And Harmony? Don't apologize to
Lyric's father.

HARMONY
I wasn't going to.

ESTHER

Yes, you were. You were going to
call him tonight after Lyric's
asleep and say you're sorry.

(beat)

Don't. Let them earn it.

HARMONY

(beat)

You say that about every man.

ESTHER

(eyes on the tower
across the street, on
one particular window
on the 58th floor of
the building beyond it
that she can't possibly
see)

Every man should have to.

She hangs up. She stays at the window.

CUT TO:

14 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – THE CATERING KITCHEN – DAY

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 3:04 PM EST

The Olson Estate's second kitchen, the one built for
four-hundred-person fundraisers: stainless steel, a
twelve-burner range, and a walk-in cooler. Right now it's
a laboratory.

GRACE BULLOCK (20), in a Spelman sweatshirt with her hair
wrapped in a silk scarf, stands at the range stirring a
double boiler with a wooden spoon. MALLORY OLSON (19), in
safety goggles and a Spelman Economics T-shirt, weighs
brown lumps of raw shea on a digital scale, reading from a
green leather notebook propped open against a flour
canister.

The TOUSSAINT FORMULARY. S.T., 1931. Handwritten in faded
ink.

GRACE

(stirring, bright)

So. Wednesday.

MALLORY

What about Wednesday?

GRACE

Don't "what about Wednesday" me. Velvet. You said you'd come. Lo's got me doing a walk-through with the owner's people about a showcase in March. It's Alvin's club.

MALLORY

Unofficially.

GRACE

Everything Uncle Alvin does is unofficially. That's how you know it's his.

(beat)

There's a new DJ on Wednesdays. Everybody's talking about him. Kiara's friend's sister says he played Minnie Riperton into Kanye and a girl fainted.

Mallory weighs another lump of shea, not looking up.

MALLORY

(beat)

Daddy doesn't like Velvet.

GRACE

Uncle Peter doesn't like anything that happens after ten o'clock that isn't surgery.

Mallory finally smiles. She pushes her goggles up on her head.

MALLORY

Fine. Wednesday. But I'm home by midnight.

GRACE

(grinning)

Sure you are.

Behind them, in the doorway to the main house, MARTIN OLSON (23) leans on the frame in shirtsleeves with a glass of mineral water. Neither girl has seen him.

He's been listening. His eyes are on the green leather book.

MARTIN

(pleasantly)

What's cooking?

Both girls jump. Mallory closes the Formulary.

MALLORY
Martin! God. Knock.

MARTIN
It's my kitchen. I grew up in it.
(strolling in, peering
at the pot)
Is that lunch?

GRACE
It's a secret.

MARTIN
(smiling)
My favorite kind.
(to Mallory)
You're going out Wednesday?

MALLORY
(guarded)
Maybe.

MARTIN
Velvet. I heard.
(beat)
Be careful there, Mal. Uncle
Alvin's club. Uncle Alvin's
friends.

MALLORY
Since when do you care where I
go?

MARTIN
(beat, gently)
I always care where you go. I
just don't always say so.

He picks up the wooden spoon and sniffs it. His eyes flick
to the green book under Mallory's hand.

MARTIN (CONT'D)
Smells expensive.

He sets the spoon down and strolls out. Mallory and Grace
look at each other.

GRACE
(quietly)

That was weird.

MALLORY
(pulling the Formulary
to her chest)
Martin's always weird.

GRACE
He knew about Velvet.

MALLORY
(beat)
I didn't tell him.

CUT TO:

**15 INT. BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES, LLP – CAMILLE RHODES'S
OFFICE – 40TH FLOOR – DAY**

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 3:47 PM EST

A glass-walled corner office in a Peachtree Street tower. Law books, a leather couch, and a framed Georgia Bar certificate: CAMILLE ANTOINETTE RHODES, 1991. A floor-to-ceiling window over Midtown.

Camille sits at her desk in a dove-gray suit, reading a brief with a red pen.

Her assistant's voice over the intercom:

ASSISTANT (V.O.)
Ms. Rhodes. Mrs. Bullock is here.

Camille looks up. The red pen stops.

CAMILLE
(beat)
For Mr. Bullock?

ASSISTANT (V.O.)
Mr. Bullock is in the Hendricks
deposition until five. She says
she'll wait with you.

A beat. Camille caps her pen.

CAMILLE
Send her in.

The door opens. Natasha enters in the ivory St. John suit and a camel coat over her arm, with a small white box from Henri's Bakery. She's radiant, relaxed, and lethal.

NATASHA

Camille. I'm so sorry to drop in.
I was downtown for the Chamber
board and I thought I'd surprise
Robert with a late lunch.
Apparently he's surprising
someone named Hendricks instead.

CAMILLE

(standing, gracious)
Natasha. What a nice surprise.
Please.

They air-kiss. Natasha holds the moment one half-second
longer than necessary, cheek to cheek.

Then she steps back and sets the bakery box on the desk.

NATASHA

Cheese straws. From Henri's.
Robert's favorite. You'll share
them with him, won't you?

CAMILLE

Of course.

Natasha sits on the leather couch without being asked and
crosses her legs. Camille sits in the chair across from
her.

A beat. Camille smiles back.

NATASHA

(pleasantly)
Six years, now? That you've been
with the firm?

CAMILLE

Fourteen, with the firm. Six as
senior partner.

NATASHA

Fourteen. Goodness. You were a
baby.

CAMILLE

I was twenty-four.

NATASHA

My daughter's age.
(beat)
Twenty-four is a very young age
to start anything.

The words land. Camille doesn't flinch.

Natasha tilts her head, as if noticing something for the first time. She breathes in, delicately.

NATASHA (CONT'D)

Oh. You're wearing it today.

CAMILLE

(beat)

Wearing what?

NATASHA

Smile. The Smilley fragrance.
Tuberose. A little green. A
little vetiver underneath, like a
secret.

(beat)

I noticed at Marc's birthday you
weren't wearing any perfume at
all. I told you it was
considerate.

CAMILLE

(evenly)

You did.

NATASHA

And now you are.

CAMILLE

It was a gift.

NATASHA

From whom?

CAMILLE

(beat)

A client.

NATASHA

A generous client. Four hundred
dollars an ounce.

(beat)

Was it a Smilley? They're so
generous right now. They're
sending gifts all over town.

CAMILLE

It was a client, Natasha. I don't
discuss clients. Privilege.

NATASHA
(delighted)
Of course. Privilege.
(beat)
Robert's very big on privilege.

She rises. She picks up her camel coat. Camille rises too.

NATASHA (CONT'D)
I won't wait after all. Tell
Robert I stopped by.

CAMILLE
I will.

NATASHA
(at the door, turning)
And Camille?

CAMILLE
Yes?

NATASHA
(sweetly)
It's a lovely scent. But it's
very strong.
(beat)
It gets into everything.
Upholstery. Car seats.
(beat)
Collars.

She walks out. The door closes behind her with a soft click.

Camille stands perfectly still.

Slowly, she sits down behind her desk. She looks at the white bakery box.

She opens it. Cheese straws, neatly lined up.

And tucked inside the lid, a small cream card, engraved N.D.B., with a single line in Natasha's elegant hand:

INSERT – THE CARD: "Enjoy them. You've already had everything else of his."

Camille closes the box.

Her hand, on the lid, is trembling.

FADE OUT.

ACT FOUR

16 INT. RAVENHURST – LUCIUS'S STUDY – DUSK

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 5:21 PM EST

Ravenhurst, the Smilley estate on the edge of Belmont Crest. The study is dark wood, green leather, and a fire. Oil portraits of Cornelius and a young Odessa. A crystal decanter of scotch.

LUCIUS SMILLEY (55), Chairman and CEO, still in his suit, sits behind his desk. He's trying to sign a stack of documents with a heavy gold pen.

His right hand shakes. The signature comes out ragged.

He switches the pen to his left hand, flexes his right, and tries again. It's worse.

VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49), elegant in black cashmere, stands at the fire with a glass of wine. She's been watching.

VIVIENNE
(quietly)
Stop.

LUCIUS
I'm fine.

VIVIENNE
You've signed your name three times, and it looks like three different men.

LUCIUS
(snapping)
Then I'll sign it four times.

VIVIENNE
(setting down her glass)
Lucius.

She crosses to him. She takes the pen out of his hand, very gently. His hand keeps trembling in the air, as if it's still holding it.

He stares at his own hand.

LUCIUS
(very low)

It's worse in the afternoon.

VIVIENNE

I know.

LUCIUS

It was only in the mornings in October.

VIVIENNE

I know, darling.

She sits on the edge of the desk beside him and takes his shaking hand in both of hers. She holds it still.

VIVIENNE (CONT'D)

Wednesday. Two o'clock. Emory. Dr. Harrington. He's the best movement-disorder man in the South. He trained at Johns Hopkins.

LUCIUS

If it's what we think it is.

VIVIENNE

Then we'll know. And then we'll decide.

LUCIUS

(beat)

Desmond can't know.

VIVIENNE

Desmond is having dinner with someone Wednesday night. He told his assistant to clear his calendar. He's too busy counting his own votes to watch your hands.

LUCIUS

Odessa knows.

VIVIENNE

Odessa knows everything. She just prices it.

(beat)

She's known since October. She hasn't said a word. That means she's waiting to see what it costs.

LUCIUS

And Esther?

Vivienne's hand tightens around his.

VIVIENNE

Esther saw it at the dinner table
last week. She looked away.

(beat)

She looked away for your sake.

LUCIUS

(beat)

She's the only one of them who
would.

VIVIENNE

She's the only one of them who's
ours.

Lucius closes his eyes.

LUCIUS

Tomorrow she's going to walk into
that boardroom and hand our
entire Atlanta real-estate book
to a girl who sells condos in
Lindbergh.

VIVIENNE

I know.

LUCIUS

Luke's going to go through the
ceiling.

VIVIENNE

I know.

(beat)

Are you going to back her?

LUCIUS

(opening his eyes)

She's my heir.

(beat)

If my hand shakes while I raise
it, you'll tell me.

VIVIENNE

(quietly)

It won't shake.

LUCIUS

How do you know?

VIVIENNE

Because I'll be sitting next to you. And I'll be holding it under the table.

She lifts his trembling hand and kisses the back of it.

VIVIENNE (CONT'D)

(standing, crisp again,
the CEO's wife)

Oh. And Delphine called from the Buckhead store. Somebody in the Donohue family is making beauty products.

LUCIUS

(beat)

Which somebody?

VIVIENNE

She doesn't know yet. But a shea cooperative in Kumasi called Delphine's buyer to ask why an American girl was asking about "Toussaint shea."

(beat)

Toussaint, Lucius.

LUCIUS

Simone Donohue's maiden name.

VIVIENNE

(picking up her wine,
looking into the fire)

In 1976 I offered that woman two million dollars for her formulas. She sent me back a jar of rose balm.

(beat)

I still have it. I've never opened it.

CUT TO:

**17 INT. DONOHUE TOWER — MARTIN'S OFFICE — 86TH FLOOR —
NIGHT**

Monday, January 10, 2005 — 6:09 PM EST

Martin's office: black glass, black leather, and a single white orchid. A view down Peachtree to Smilley Tower, lit up in gold.

On the wall, a bank of four TVs. On one of them, WBKG's six o'clock news replays Saturday's funeral footage again. The two rows of men. Silas and Mama Dee on the steps, arm in arm.

Martin stands in front of the screen with his hands in his pockets.

MARTIN
(to the TV, softly)
Holding hands.

On the desk, a small pile of printouts: Celeste Vaughn's courthouse counts, marked up in red. A battered paperback of The Prince sits on the credenza, dog-eared, its spine cracked white.

His desk phone. Not the office line. A second phone, black, with no display. He picks it up and dials a long number from memory. International.

He waits. Then:

MARTIN (CONT'D)
(into phone, pleasant)
It's me.
(beat)
It's after midnight there, I know. I thought you'd still be up. You never sleep before the tables close.
(listening)
They buried him Saturday.
(beat)
Together. Merriweather's men on the left, and his on the right. The old woman from the restaurant walked in on Silas Merriweather's arm. It led every newscast in the city.
(listening)
Yes. There's a nephew. Theodore. They call him Teddy.
(a small smile)
I thought you'd like that.
(listening)
Young. Hungry. Thinks his uncle's gotten soft. He stared across the church hall at the Mayfield boy

the whole repast.

(beat)

That's where it breaks. Not with Silas. With the young ones. Old men make truces. Young men don't honor them.

(listening)

No. Not yet. I'm not calling anyone yet.

(beat)

I'm having dinner Wednesday with a man who has the same problem I have.

(listening)

Smilley. The brother.

(beat)

Because his niece is the heir, and he holds sixteen votes out of a hundred. He needs friends to stop her. Or debts.

(listening, then quietly)

Yes. I understand.

(beat)

I remember what you told me. "Never make a man an ally. Make him a creditor. Allies leave."

(beat)

Good night.

He hangs up. He sets the black phone in the desk drawer and locks it.

He looks back at the TV. The footage has moved on to the weather.

He picks up a red pen and walks to a whiteboard on the wall, hidden behind a sliding lacquer panel. He slides it open.

On the board, in Martin's neat handwriting, a list:

INSERT — THE WHITEBOARD:

"1. MERRIWEATHER — TEDDY?

2. APD — HUGHES (leaking. Good.)

3. FBI — DEEP WATER (Savannah)

4. SMILLEY — DESMOND (Wed. 9 PM, Ritz)

5. ROBERT — C. RHODES (since '99?)"

He picks up the red pen. He draws a circle around "ROBERT." Twice.

He caps the pen. He slides the panel shut.

MARTIN (CONT'D)
(to himself, pleased)
Everybody's so busy.

CUT TO:

18 INT. BELLE RIVE – THE FAMILY DINING ROOM – NIGHT
Monday, January 10, 2005 – 6:52 PM EST

Not the formal dining room. The family one, off the kitchen: a round walnut table for six, a chandelier on a dimmer, and French doors onto the dark terrace. Nana Ruby's pot roast steams in a Le Creuset in the middle of the table, with rice, gravy, and green beans.

Robert sits at the head, loosened tie, in a good mood. Grace, still in her Spelman sweatshirt, sits to his left, talking with her hands. Natasha sits at the foot, in a cream silk blouse, serving the plates.

Ruby moves in and out of the kitchen door with rolls.

NATASHA
I stopped by the firm after.

A tiny beat. Robert keeps cutting.

ROBERT
Did you? I was stuck in Hendricks all afternoon.

NATASHA
Camille told me. I sat with her a while.

ROBERT
(beat)
That was nice of you.

NATASHA
It was nice of her. She's very gracious.
(beat)
And she smells wonderful.

Grace, reaching for a roll, doesn't catch any of it.

GRACE

Camille always smells good. At
the Christmas party she smelled
like a Nordstrom.

Robert laughs a little too loudly. Natasha lifts her water
glass.

NATASHA

(to Grace)

What else did you girls make
today?

GRACE

Rose balm. Batch one. It's not
right yet. Mal says the shea's
too young. But Mama, listen, this
is the weird part.

(leaning in)

Somebody called the co-op in
Kumasi before we did. Asking
about Toussaint shea. Mal called
three times. The lady won't say
who. She just says "an American
woman, very polite, very rich."

NATASHA

(beat)

Very polite, very rich.

GRACE

Who even knows about Kumasi?
Grandma Simone kept that book in
a drawer since 1946.

NATASHA

(evenly)

Vivienne Smilley.

Robert's fork stops.

GRACE

(beat)

Who?

NATASHA

Vivienne Smilley. She tried to
buy those formulas from your
great-grandmother in 1976.
Through a lawyer in Paris. Two
million dollars.

(beat)

Grandma Simone sent her a jar of
rose balm and a note that said
"No, thank you."

GRACE
(stunned)
The perfume lady?

NATASHA
The perfume lady.

GRACE
The SMILE lady?

NATASHA
(sipping her water,
eyes on Robert)
The Smile lady.

Robert sets down his fork. He picks up his wine.

ROBERT
Well. That's the Smilleys. They
want everything we've got.

NATASHA
(beat)
Don't they.

Ruby, coming through the kitchen door with the gravy boat,
stops for half a second in the doorway. Then she comes in
and sets it down in front of Robert.

RUBY
More gravy, Mr. Robert.

ROBERT
Thank you, Ruby.

RUBY
(pleasantly)
You're gonna need it.

She goes back into the kitchen. Grace looks from her
father to her mother.

GRACE
(slowly)
Is something going on?

ROBERT AND NATASHA
(together)
No, baby.

They look at each other down the length of the table.

Grace, twenty, a pop star, not stupid, picks up her roll and chews very slowly.

FADE OUT.

ACT FIVE

19 INT. RAVENHURST – THE NURSERY – NIGHT

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 7:44 PM EST

A fairy-tale nursery: pale-pink walls hand-painted with a Parisian carousel, two white canopy beds, and a rocking horse with a real horsehair mane. A night-light shaped like a crescent moon.

EMMA SMILLEY (2) and VICTORIA SMILLEY (2), in matching yellow pajamas, sit on the rug in front of a little easel covered in paper and fat crayons. NANNY BEA PENNINGTON (43), Norland-trained, cardigan and sensible shoes, sits in a rocking chair with her knitting.

Esther, still in her work clothes with her shoes off, kneels on the rug between her daughters.

Victoria has been drawing very seriously with a brown crayon. She holds up her paper: a big round face with enormous teeth, a huge scribbled grin, and two dots for eyes.

VICTORIA

Mama. Funny man.

Esther freezes.

ESTHER

(carefully)

Who's that, Dividend?

VICTORIA

(pointing at the

drawing, insistent)

FUNNY man.

And then she laughs. Her big, loud, delighted, head-thrown-back laugh.

That laugh.

In the rocking chair, Bea's needles stop clicking.

ESTHER

(quietly)

Where did you see the funny man, baby?

VICTORIA
(pointing at the
window)
Outside!

Esther looks at the window. Beyond it, across the dark lawn, over the tall hedges, the lights of Belmont Crest glitter on the ridge.

BEA
(gently, going back to
her knitting)
She sees him on the television,
Miss Esther. The Bullock boy. He
was on the news last week,
carrying food off an airplane in
Sri Lanka, and then on the local
program with his birthday cake.
Miss Victoria stands right up to
the screen.
(beat)
She has the most discerning taste
in comedians.

Esther doesn't turn around.

ESTHER
(evenly)
She's two, Bea. Everything's a
funny man.

BEA
(knitting)
Of course, Miss Esther.

A knock at the doorframe. ODESSA SMILLEY (84) stands there, silver-haired and ramrod straight, in a dark-plum dressing gown, leaning on an ebony cane with a gold handle.

ODESSA
Is there room for an old woman in
the land of ponies?

EMMA
GIGI!

The twins scramble up and throw themselves at Odessa's knees. She plants her cane and bends, with great ceremony, to kiss the tops of both their heads.

ODESSA

Beatrix. Take the ladies for
their bath. I need a word with
their mother.

BEA

(rising)

Yes, Madame Smilley. Come along,
my darlings. Bath time. Bubbles.

TWINS

BUBBLES!

Bea herds them out. As she passes, Victoria reaches back
for her drawing. Esther holds it out of her reach with a
smile.

ESTHER

I'll keep it safe for you.

The door closes. Odessa lowers herself into the rocking
chair with a small sigh. Esther stays kneeling on the rug,
holding the drawing.

ODESSA

Tomorrow, your uncle will say
nothing at all. He'll sit there
and let Luke and Delphine bleed
on the table, and afterward he'll
count who bled.

(beat)

Desmond is having dinner with
someone Wednesday night.

ESTHER

(looking up)

With whom?

ODESSA

I don't know yet. That's what
worries me. I always know.

A beat. Odessa rocks.

ODESSA (CONT'D)

Your father will vote with you.

ESTHER

I know.

ODESSA

Do you know why?

ESTHER
Because I'm his heir.

ODESSA
Because he's frightened, and
you're the only one of his
children who doesn't frighten
him.
(beat)
That's not the same thing as
love, but in this family it's the
closest thing we've got.

Esther looks down at the drawing in her hands. The big,
grinning face.

ODESSA (CONT'D)
(watching her)
What's that?

ESTHER
(beat)
Victoria's art.

ODESSA
Let me see.

Esther hesitates, then holds it up. Odessa looks at it for
a long moment.

ODESSA (CONT'D)
(dryly)
A man with a great many teeth.

ESTHER
She calls him "Funny man."

ODESSA
(beat)
Does she.

Odessa rocks once. Twice.

ODESSA (CONT'D)
Esther. You've been to that gate
twice in one week.
(off Esther's look)
Mr. Crowe reports to your father.
Your father tells your mother.
Your mother tells me everything,
because she's afraid of me.

ESTHER

(beat)

Mrs. Donohue invited me.

ODESSA

She invited you once. You went twice.

(beat)

And both times you turned around.

Esther rises from the floor. She folds the drawing in half, then in half again, and slips it into the pocket of her trousers.

ESTHER

(evenly)

I told you last week. I'm not afraid of Simone Donohue.

ODESSA

(beat)

No, darling. I believe you.

(beat)

I've never once seen you afraid of an old woman.

She lets that sit. Then she rises on her cane, and pats Esther's cheek on her way to the door.

ODESSA (CONT'D)

Wear the gray tomorrow. Red is for parties. Gray is for war.

She goes. Esther stands alone in the moonlit nursery.

From down the hall, the sound of splashing, and then Victoria's laugh again.

Esther closes her eyes.

CUT TO:

**20 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD – BLACKWATER TASK FORCE
FLOOR – NIGHT**

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 8:26 PM EST

The half-unpacked task force floor. The whiteboards have grown: LAMAR WHITLOCK, EARL TUGGLE, the traffic-cam still of the white van, the burned-out van in Clayton County.

A new section: SATURDAY – THE FUNERAL. A row of surveillance photographs taken by APD's own long lens: the

Merriweather men on the left side of the stairs, the other men on the right.

Elxa stands in front of the board with a marker. Jeremy sits on a desk eating Chinese food out of a carton.

She ignores him. She pins up a new photo: Silas Merriweather stepping out of his Cadillac, offering his crooked left hand back into the car.

Then another: the woman in the black hat and veil taking that hand.

ELXA
Dolores Whitfield.

JEREMY
(chewing)
Mama Dee.

ELXA
Fifty-three. Owns Dee's Kitchen
on Ralph David Abernathy since
1981. No record. Not even a
parking ticket. Widowed in 1975.
(beat)
Silas Merriweather buried him.
For free.

JEREMY
That's a nice story.

ELXA
It's a thirty-year story.
(beat)
And on Saturday, twenty
Merriweather men and twenty men
nobody can name straightened
their backs when she got out of
that car.

Jeremy sets down his carton.

JEREMY
Elx.

ELXA
I know.

JEREMY
She's a church lady who makes
pies.

ELXA

Every one of those men looked at
her before they looked at Silas.

(beat)

Jeremy, I've been looking for
Blackwater in the wrong places.
I've been looking for a man in a
black car. Maybe I should've been
looking at who everybody looks
at.

She takes a marker and writes under Mama Dee's photo:
"WHITFIELD - ???"

Then, under the photos of the unnamed men on the right
side of the steps, she writes: "WHO ARE THEY?"

She stands back. Jeremy comes up beside her.

JEREMY

(quietly)

The FBI shot the same pictures.

ELXA

I know.

JEREMY

Doyle wrote down the restaurant.
I saw her do it through the
windshield.

ELXA

(beat)

Then we'd better get there first.

Jeremy looks at Mama Dee's photograph. The veil. The calm.

JEREMY

My mama eats at Dee's every
Sunday after church.

ELXA

So does half this city.

JEREMY

(beat)

That's what I'm afraid of.

Elxa caps the marker.

CUT TO:

21 EXT. BELMONT CREST — THE RIVER GATE — NIGHT

Monday, January 10, 2005 — 8:59 PM EST

The black Chattahoochee, running high and cold. No moon.
The iron lantern over the boathouse door.

One by one, down the bluff path, a few minutes apart: Mama Dee with a covered dish. Saint. Roman. Tobias with a leather portfolio instead of his laptop. Keisha with her hood up. Amond, the handprint on his cheek faded to a pink shadow.

Two knocks each.

INT. THE RIVER GATE BOATHOUSE — THE TABLE — CONTINUOUS

Monday, January 10, 2005 — 9:04 PM EST

The black-lacquered Table. The iron chandelier and its candles. The river moving beneath the floorboards.

Seven chairs filled. The Eighth, at the far end, empty, its black velvet seat catching the candlelight.

Marc at the head, in a black sweater. Sovereign.

Mama Dee uncovers a dish: peach cobbler. She starts spooning it into bowls.

MAMA DEE

Eat first.

SAINT

(already reaching)

Then we'll talk about who needs
to disappear.

MAMA DEE

(slapping his hand
lightly with the spoon)

Don't you steal my line, Rashad.

A ripple of laughter. Amond doesn't laugh. Marc sees it.
He lets it go.

MARC

Mama Dee. The funeral.

MAMA DEE

(sitting, folding her
hands)

It went the way it was supposed
to go. Twenty and twenty, both

rails. Nobody spoke, nobody touched, nobody even spat. Reverend Peavy preached the deacon home. Saint gave Bernice the mortgage.

MARC

And Silas?

MAMA DEE

(beat)

Silas says he'll be patient. A Merriweather kind of patience. It runs out on a Tuesday, and it doesn't tell you on the Monday.

(beat)

He has a nephew. Teddy. His sister's boy. Twenty-six, maybe. Nice suit, no sense. He stared a hole through Saint all through the repast.

SAINT

He wanted me to say something.

MARC

Did you?

SAINT

I ate a chicken wing at him.

ROMAN

(quietly, the first thing he's said)

That's the break point.

Everybody looks at Roman.

ROMAN (CONT'D)

Not Silas. Silas is sixty. Silas has made his peace with how the world is. Teddy's twenty-six. Somebody who wants a war doesn't go to the general. He goes to the lieutenant who thinks the general's gone soft.

MARC

(beat)

Saint. Put somebody on Teddy. Somebody he won't notice. I want to know who he eats with.

SAINT

Done.

MARC

Ghost.

KEISHA

(sliding a single sheet
into the middle of the
table)

Germany's clear. Both shops. One
of them makes gravestones in
Idar-Oberstein and hasn't taken a
foreign order since the Wall came
down.

(beat)

Five left. India, two. Hong Kong.
Israel. South Africa.

(beat)

And our deputy chief called WBKG
at eleven-forty Saturday night.
The funeral. Then somebody faxed
the Chief's command-staff report
to the FBI field office from a
Kinko's on Ponce. Saturday
morning.

MARC

(beat)

And Elxa?

KEISHA

She knows it's him. She just
can't prove it. Thursday she's
going to try.

MARC

(very quietly, almost
proud)

She'll get him.

Mama Dee glances at him. She's the only one who catches
the note in his voice.

MARC (CONT'D)

Tobias.

Tobias doesn't open the portfolio right away. He puts both
hands flat on it.

TOBIAS

Chatham Savings and Trust.
Founded 1919. Two branches, both
in Savannah. Four hundred and
twelve accounts. Old shipping
families, port pilots,
stevedoring companies, a couple
of judges. The kind of bank where
the president still sends a
Christmas ham.

(beat)

The Fed shipped them eight
hundred thousand in new hundreds
on December sixth. Standard
currency order. On December
ninth, sixty thousand of it
walked out the door as a cash
withdrawal from one commercial
account.

(beat)

Twenty thousand ended up in Lamar
Whitlock's savings account the
next morning.

ROMAN

And the other forty?

TOBIAS

Don't know yet.

MARC

Whose account, Tobias?

Tobias opens the portfolio. He takes out one sheet, a
photocopy of a signature card, and slides it down the
table to Marc.

TOBIAS

(evenly)

Harbour Point Logistics, LLC. A
customs brokerage and
freight-forwarding company in
Garden City, Georgia. Right
outside the port.

(beat)

It's a wholly owned subsidiary of
Donohue Shipping.

Silence. The river moves under the floor.

Saint's chair comes down on four legs.

MARC
(very still)
Say that again.

TOBIAS
Harbour Point Logistics is owned
by Donohue Shipping. Donohue
Shipping is owned by Donohue
Enterprises. Donohue Enterprises
is owned by DGH.
(beat)
The money that paid Lamar
Whitlock came out of your
family's company, Marc.

Nobody moves. Keisha looks at the table. Mama Dee looks at
Marc. Amond looks at the signature card.

AMOND
Who signed for the withdrawal?

TOBIAS
Chatham's a hundred-year-old
bank. The teller's slip says
"Authorized Agent" and a scrawl.
The authorized signers on the
account are the company's
president, a man named Gerald
Pettaway, who's seventy-one and
has been in a nursing home in
Pooler since August—
(beat)
—and "such other agents as the
parent company may designate in
writing."

ROMAN
So anybody at Donohue Shipping.

TOBIAS
Anybody at Donohue Shipping who
has a letter on DGH letterhead.

A long, terrible silence.

MAMA DEE
(quietly)
Baby.

MARC
(beat)
I'm fine.

MAMA DEE

I didn't ask if you were fine. I
said baby.

Marc picks up the signature card. He looks at it. He sets
it down very precisely, squared to the edge of the table.

MARC

(evenly)

This stays at this table. Nobody
outside these seven chairs.

(beat)

Not Arianna. Not the General. Not
my family.

TOBIAS

Understood.

MARC

Tobias. I want every Harbour
Point transaction since the day
Donohue Shipping bought it. Every
wire, every withdrawal, every
customs filing. And the other
forty thousand.

TOBIAS

Yes.

MARC

Roman. I want to know who at
Donohue Shipping can write a
letter on DGH letterhead. Every
name. Quietly. Nobody in Savannah
knows we asked.

ROMAN

Yes.

MARC

Ghost. Keep going on the shops. I
want the one that made those
coins.

KEISHA

You'll have it this week.

MARC

Saint. Teddy.

SAINT

Done.

MARC

Mama Dee.

MAMA DEE

Yes, baby.

MARC

Tell Silas the proof is coming.

(beat)

And tell him that when I find the
man who did this, he's going to
be very surprised whose name is
on him.

Mama Dee holds his eyes a long time. Then she nods.

MARC (CONT'D)

Amond. Stay.

The others rise. They go one by one. Keisha squeezes
Marc's shoulder on the way past, which she never does.
Saint takes two bowls of cobbler with him. Mama Dee pauses
at the door.

MAMA DEE

(to Marc)

Whoever it is. Blood or no blood.

MARC

Blood or no blood.

She goes. The door closes. Just Marc and Amond now, and
the Eighth Chair.

AMOND

(not sitting down)

Harmony Divine hit me today.

MARC

(looking at the pink
shadow on his cheek)

I can see.

AMOND

I offered to find her brother. A
team. Ghost's analysts, Roman's
people, traffic cams, pawn
tickets. She said I think money
fixes everything.

(beat)

It's the one thing we're actually
good at, Marc. We found the
Delgado girl in Juárez in four

days.

MARC
Don't put BSI on it.

AMOND
Why not?

MARC
Because she said no. And because
the DA's office has a GBI veteran
on it now. Forty of our operators
knocking on the same doors as a
Fulton County investigator isn't
help, Mond. It's obstruction.
(beat)
And the DA is Ari.

AMOND
(beat)
Since when do you care about
obstruction?
(beat)
Saint says your car was parked on
Northside Drive Friday night.

The candles gutter.

MARC
Saint talks too much.

AMOND
Saint never talks. That's why I
noticed.

MARC
Ari had a bad night. She called
me. I went.
(beat)
That's the whole story.

AMOND
(beat)
Okay.

MARC
You said okay like a man who's
going to go look.

AMOND
(beat)
Maybe I am.

MARC
(quietly)
Mond. I'm asking you. As your
brother.
(beat)
Not as Sovereign. As your
brother. Don't put anybody on Dee
Divine.

A very long beat. The two of them look at each other
across eighteen years of friendship and one secret.

AMOND
(finally)
You've never had to ask me as
your brother before.

MARC
I know.

AMOND
That's how I know it's bad.

He picks up a bowl of cobbler. He walks to the door. He
stops with his hand on it.

AMOND (CONT'D)
(without turning
around)
I won't put anybody on it.
(beat)
But she's the mother of my
daughter, Marc. And if I find out
that whatever you're not telling
me is going to hurt her—
(beat)
Then we're going to have a very
different conversation. Not as
brothers.

He goes. The door closes.

Marc sits alone at the head of the Table. He looks down
the length of it at the Eighth Chair.

MARC
(quietly, to the empty
chair)
It's getting harder to fill the
ones I've got.

FADE OUT.

ACT SIX**22 INT. DONOHUE MANOR — THE LIBRARY — NIGHT**

Monday, January 10, 2005 — 10:14 PM EST

The library. The fire burns low. The quilt and pillow are folded neatly on the end of the Chesterfield. Night five.

Victor sits in his armchair in his pajamas and silk robe. Anna Karenina lies face down on his knee. He isn't reading it. He's looking at the fire.

A soft knock. The door opens. Marc slips in, still in the black sweater, holding a foil-covered plate.

MARC

(low)

Room service.

VICTOR

(not turning)

If that's from your grandmother,
tell her I've been fed.

MARC

It's not from Grandma.

(setting it on the side
table, peeling back the
foil)

It's from Mama Dee's. Peach
cobbler.

Victor looks. He looks for a long time.

VICTOR

(beat)

Dee's Kitchen.

MARC

You used to take me there on
Saturdays after the barbershop.
Before you had a driver.

VICTOR

I always had a driver. I just
didn't take him to the West End.
(picking up the fork,
taking one bite,
closing his eyes)
God help me.

MARC

Good?

VICTOR

Your grandmother is going to know.

MARC

How? She's asleep.

VICTOR

Your grandmother has been married to me for forty-five years. She'll smell it on me at breakfast.

MARC

(sitting on the arm of the Chesterfield)

Then she'll know somebody loves you.

Victor almost smiles. Then he sets the fork down.

VICTOR

You didn't come here with cobbler at ten o'clock at night because you missed me.

MARC

I did miss you.

VICTOR

And?

Marc looks at the fire.

MARC

Harbour Point Logistics.

Victor's face doesn't change. That's how Marc knows he's heard the name before.

VICTOR

(evenly)

A customs brokerage in Garden City. Donohue Shipping bought it in 1998. The old man who ran it, Gerald Pettaway, had no sons, and he didn't want the Maersk people to have it. He came to me personally. We paid him more than it was worth, and we let him keep

his office.
(beat)
It files paperwork on the
Savannah containers. Customs
declarations. Bonds. It's the
least interesting company we own.
(beat)
Why?

MARC
Curiosity.

VICTOR
(sharply)
You've never been curious a day
in your life. You're either
certain or you're asleep.

A beat. Marc meets his eyes.

MARC
The FBI file. Operation Deep
Water. It names Donohue Shipping.
The Port of Savannah.

VICTOR
Your grandmother told me.

MARC
If somebody's using Harbour
Point—

VICTOR
(cutting him off)
If somebody is using my company,
I'll know by Friday.

MARC
Granddaddy—

VICTOR
(rising, the robe
falling around him like
a king's)
Marc-Anthony. I ran this company
for thirty years. I have been
Chairman for nine more. I know
the name of every man who has
ever signed a Donohue check over
a hundred thousand dollars. I
know which of them drink, which
of them pray, and which of them
have a second family in

Tallahassee.

(beat)

If someone is using my ships, my
port, or my paper, I will know
who by Friday.

(beat)

And on Saturday, they won't work
anywhere on this earth again.

Marc looks up at him. Sixty-eight years old in pajamas,
and absolutely nobody to trifle with.

MARC

(quietly)

Yes, sir.

VICTOR

(sitting again, picking
up the fork)

And you won't tell me why you
asked.

MARC

No, sir.

VICTOR

(beat, eating cobbler)

Good. I've decided not to ask.

(beat)

Remember what I told you on your
birthday.

MARC

"Carry it like a Donohue."

VICTOR

Like it weighs nothing.

(beat)

You're not doing a very good job
tonight.

Marc laughs, low, and it's real. He stands. He kisses the
top of his grandfather's head, which he hasn't done since
he was a boy.

MARC

Two more nights.

VICTOR

Two more nights.

Marc goes to the door.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

Marc.

Marc turns.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

(not looking up from
the cobbler)

Tell Dolores Whitfield the crust
is better than it was in 1994.

MARC

(beat, careful)

I'll tell her.

He goes. Victor eats alone by the fire.

He sets down his fork. He picks up the phone on the side
table. He dials four digits from memory. An internal line.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

(into phone)

Winston. I'm sorry to wake you.

(beat)

Call Donohue Shipping's general
counsel at home. I want him in my
office at seven o'clock tomorrow
morning. With the Harbour Point
file.

(beat)

No, Winston. Not Martin. Just the
counsel.

(beat)

Thank you.

He hangs up. He picks the book back up.

Somewhere far down the hall, a woman's footsteps pass the
library door and pause. Joan. Then they keep going.

CUT TO:

**23 INT. THE CUMMINGS ESTATE – 41 KINGSRIDGE DRIVE –
ARIANNA'S BEDROOM – NIGHT**

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 10:37 PM EST

Arianna's childhood bedroom, which she has never moved out
of. Law books on shelves beside debate trophies. A Spelman
pennant. A window seat overlooking the dark garden and the
white gazebo.

Arianna sits on the floor of her walk-in closet in a Spelman T-shirt and sweatpants, surrounded by open shoeboxes.

She's looking for something.

In one box, she finds it. A stiff, cream-colored invitation, printed in gold:

INSERT – THE INVITATION: "Dr. and Mrs. Walter Henderson request the pleasure of your company to ring in 2002. December 31, 2001. Nine o'clock until the new year. 3244 Northside Drive NW. Black tie."

She reads it. She turns it over. On the back, in her own handwriting, nineteen-year-old loops: "Designated driver = ME!!! (lol)"

She stares at it.

Slowly, she presses the invitation to her mouth. She shakes silently.

Then she sets it back in the shoebox. She puts the lid on. She puts the shoebox on the top shelf of the closet, all the way in the back, behind her old debate trophies.

She stands. She turns off the closet light.

On her nightstand, her cell phone lights up. A text message. From MARC:

INSERT – THE TEXT: "sleep. i've got it."

She looks at it for a long time.

She doesn't answer. She lies down on top of the covers with her eyes open.

CUT TO:

24 INT. BELLE RIVE – NATASHA'S STUDY – NIGHT

Monday, January 10, 2005 – 10:48 PM EST

A jewel-box study off the master suite: peacock-blue walls, a Louis XV writing desk, framed photos of Natasha with three presidents, and Alexander's portrait over the mantel. A single lamp burns.

Natasha sits at the desk in a silk robe. In front of her, on the blotter, lies a flat white Hermès box.

She lifts the lid. Inside, perfectly folded in tissue, is Robert's white shirt.

She looks at it. Then she replaces the lid.

She picks up the phone. She dials a number from a small leather address book.

It rings twice.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
(filtered, awake
instantly)
Greer.

NATASHA
Nathaniel. It's Natasha Donohue
Bullock.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
Mrs. Bullock. Good evening. Is
something wrong at one of the
properties?

NATASHA
No. Everything's fine at the
properties. That's why I'm
calling you and not the police.
(beat)
Nathaniel. You're the Director of
Global Security for Donohue
Hotels and Resorts. Forty-one
properties. Nineteen countries.
(beat)
I want every reservation made in
the name of Robert J. Bullock, at
any Donohue property, anywhere in
the world, going back to 1999.

A pause on the line.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
(carefully)
Mr. Bullock. Your husband.

NATASHA
My husband.
(beat)
And every reservation in the name
of Camille A. Rhodes.
R-H-O-D-E-S. Same dates. Same
properties. Any property. Any
city.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

(beat)

Ma'am. I— With respect, ma'am,
that's personal information on a—

NATASHA

Every reservation. Every
room-service ticket. Every late
checkout. Every time a key card
was cut for a second guest.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

(quietly)

Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA

And Nathaniel.

(beat)

Going forward, if either of those
names books a room at any Donohue
property in the world, I want to
know before the key card is cut.

(beat)

Not after. Before.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

Yes, Mrs. Bullock.

NATASHA

This is between you and me. Not
the hotel division president. Not
my father. Not my husband.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

Understood, ma'am.

NATASHA

Thank you, Nathaniel. Good night.

She hangs up. She sits back.

On the desk, the Hermès box.

Over the mantel, Alexander Donohue looks down at his
granddaughter from 1965, stern and proud.

Natasha looks up at him.

NATASHA (CONT'D)

(quietly)

You always said we built the
hotels so we'd never have to be
turned away at the front desk.

(beat)
You never said what to do when
the front desk is the only one
who knows.

Down the hall, a door opens. Robert's voice, sleepy,
calling from the master suite:

ROBERT (O.S.)
Tash? You coming to bed?

Natasha puts the Hermès box in the bottom drawer of her
writing desk. She locks it with a tiny gold key. She drops
the key into the pocket of her robe.

NATASHA
(calling back, warm,
perfect)
Coming, baby.

She turns off the lamp.

In the dark, the tiny gold key catches the last of the
firelight as she walks out.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE #0006

NEXT ON BEYOND THE KINGDOM...

— On the 72nd floor of Smilley Tower, ESTHER stands before the board and names her secret weapon: "Harmony Divine will broker every Smilley land deal in Atlanta." LUKE: "Over my dead body." LUCIUS: "Then we'll miss you."

— At Keel & Associates, the whole office goes silent as HARMONY walks back to her cubicle beside the restroom door, now the most envied agent in Buckhead.

— On the 88th floor of Donohue Tower, NATASHA reads the Sentinel's business wire and hands it to VICTOR: "The Smilleys just hired Lyric's mother."

FADE TO BLACK.